



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: American Heritage Schools of Florida
School Website: <https://www.ahschool.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

American Heritage Schools Florida (AH Florida) presents a strong private, college-preparatory program with notable strengths in faculty quality, fine arts, and pre-professional pathways. Public-facing materials emphasize high academic outcomes (AP performance, National Merit/Presidential Scholar candidates) and a family-oriented community, signaling clear virtues such as integrity and compassion. However, the school's public materials do not explicitly foreground the core classical markers—liberal arts foundations (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation, or a distinctly Socratic pedagogy—nor do they overtly articulate a theological or liturgical metaphysical program. Taken together, AH Florida sits at the intersection of high-quality, college-prep private schooling and some elements aligned with classical aims, but it stops short of a full classical education model in its published materials.

Overall classification (aggregate): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - Strengths aligned with classical cues: virtue-related language in mission statements (integrity, compassion), strong teacher dedication, and a robust, college-prep culture with extensive AP offerings and pre-professional programs. This supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating in several categories, particularly Faculty and Parents/Community. Evidence: mission statements emphasizing integrity/knowledge/compassion and a family-oriented community; dedicated faculty; AP and pre-professional programs; strong arts and STEM pathways. - Moderate to no explicit classical curriculum signals: absence (in public-facing content) of explicit liberal-arts scaffolding (grammar/logical/rhetorical tracts), Great Books/Great Conversation, or clearly stated Scholé/quiet-wonder pedagogy; minimal reference to liturgical/metaphysical underpinnings. This weighs toward NOT CLASSICAL in Curriculum and Pedagogy categories. Evidence: descriptions of college prep, arts, and STEM, but little on Great Books, classical trivium/quadrivium, or Socratic seminars. - Category-by-category balance: Religious Metaphysical Foundations (some virtue-based language; not theology-focused) and Curriculum/Pedagogy show the strongest misalignment with classical criteria, while Faculty and Parents/Community show meaningful alignment. The aggregate tilt is toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with clear opportunities to advance to CLASSICAL through explicit curriculum and pedagogy changes. The classical-keyword framework (from the Six Essential Elements) provides concrete targets AH Florida could pursue to reach CLASSICAL status across all six categories.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's public materials foreground character formation themes, integrity, and compassion as core values in its mission and community description. For example, the Palm Beach campus materials emphasize a "warm, family-oriented community" and a long-standing mission oriented toward knowledge, integrity, and compassion to develop the full potential of each child. This language signals moral formation and virtuous development as aims of education. - The school positions itself as a college-prep institution with a strong emphasis on character, leadership, and service through multiple programs and clubs, which aligns with virtue-formation notions even if explicit theology/liturgy is not stated.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: integrity, compassion, knowledge (proximate to virtue and moral formation). These terms align with the Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements (virtue, moral formation, integrity; reverence/wonder are less explicit here). - Negative keywords found:

none clearly present in the public materials (no explicit signaling of secular relativism, value-neutrality, or moral subjectivism in the accessible public copy).

Why this rating - The presence of virtue-based language (integrity, compassion) and a community-centered mission indicates alignment with the moral-realist/virtue-oriented strand of the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations category, but there is no explicit theological or liturgical program described in public materials. The absence of liturgical/ontological language and explicit theology lowers it from CLASSICAL to SOME-WHAT CLASSICAL in this category. The evidence suggests formation of character rather than a robust metaphysical/theological program.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - AH Florida emphasizes college preparation and overall academic excellence as central aims, including top rankings, National Merit/Presidential Scholar outcomes, and a broad college-prep curriculum. This focus on college/career readiness and metrics is explicit across campus materials and blog/new content. - The mission statements frame education primarily as preparation for higher education and accomplishment within a private-school, college-prep ecosystem rather than forming humans toward the classical telos (truth, goodness, beauty) and moral imagination as primary ends. The classical ideal of formation for human flourishing beyond vocational outcomes is not the explicit stated telos in public postings.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, human flourishing, liberal education (in the classical lexicon sense) are not explicitly named; instead, “formation” as a concept is implied by the mission to develop the full potential and to prepare students for college. The public material contains many references to “college preparation” and achievement metrics. These are not strong matches to the Positive Keyword set focused on telos, true/good/beautiful, and virtue formation as ends. The strongest match is “formation” in a formed sense, but not in the explicit classical sense. 0–1 explicit matches to Positive Keywords per the Six Essential Elements. - Negative keywords present: none prominently (no explicit emphasis on workforce-readiness as the sole goal; rather, college prep is prominent). The Negative Keywords list includes signals like “college placement” as a potential misalignment, but in AH’s public materials, college prep is central. 0 explicit Negative Keywords observed.

Why this rating - The school’s predominant aim appears to be college preparation and private-school excellence rather than formation toward the classical telos of truth, goodness, and beauty as primary ends. This leans toward NOT CLASSICAL in this category, given the absence of explicit classical telos-oriented language and formation-centered aims beyond securing future admissions.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum emphasis is described as “college prep curriculum” with extensive AP offerings, pre-professional programs (Pre-Law, Pre-Med, Pre-Engineering, etc.), and a strong Fine Arts/Technology/STEM mix. The presence of 147 courses and college-prep pathways is highlighted, but there is no explicit mention of Classical curriculum elements like grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, or the Great Conversation in public-facing content. - Pre-professional offerings and robotics/engineering programs indicate a STEM- and specialization-forward approach rather than a liberal-arts-bent structure. The presence of Pre-Engineering and robotics competitions demonstrates project- or experiential-leaning elements, which may conflict with classical curricular signals that emphasize the liberal arts canon and Great Books.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: few to none from the classical lexicon (e.g., Great Books, liberal education, grammars/logic/rhetoric, classic canon). The site highlights “college prep curriculum,” Fine Arts, AP, Pre-Professional programs; not aligned with classical curriculum signals. 0–1 explicit matches. - Negative keywords found: the presence of project-based or experiential-leaning cues is not clearly stated as a negative in AH’s public content; however, the Six Essential Elements explicitly flags “project-based learning dominance” as a negative signal for Curriculum. AH content emphasizes AP/pre-professional tracks rather than a Great-Books or grammar-logic-rhetoric canonical curriculum. 0 explicit Negative Keywords observed in public text.

Why this rating - The explicit classical curriculum signals (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; history as a central through-line) are not present in the public-facing AH Florida materials. The curriculum is robust and college-prep oriented with modern modalities (AP, Pre-Professional, Fine Arts, STEM), which places it firmly outside the classical curriculum rubric as defined by the Six Essential Elements. This yields a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - There is no explicit mention of Socratic seminars, scholé days, or classical memory work in AH's public-facing pedagogy language. Public content emphasizes rigorous coursework (AP, labs, college prep) and personalized tutoring but lacks the specific classical pedagogy signals (Socratic dialogue, narration/recitation, chanting, memory work, or a living curriculum as the central classroom method). - The school highlights engagement through arts, robotics, and pre-professional programs rather than explicitly stating a contemplative, memory-based, or classical pedagogy framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: none clearly (no explicit Socratic seminars, scholé, or classical memory pedagogy). 0 explicit matches to the Classical Pedagogy signals. - Negative keywords found: the Six Essential Elements list "negative signals" for Pedagogy include experiential learning focus, project-based instruction, or constructivist approaches as not aligned with classical pedagogy. AH content does not clearly signal a dominant experiential-only pedagogy; it emphasizes AP coursework and modern instructional practices, which does not map cleanly to classical pedagogy or its explicit negatives. 0 explicit Negative Keywords observed in public text.

Why this rating - Absence of explicit classical pedagogical practices (Socratic seminars, scholé, narration/recitation, etc.) places Pedagogy in NOT CLASSICAL based on the public-facing materials. The presence of modern instructional modalities (AP, tutoring, labs) suggests a contemporary, college-prep pedagogy rather than a classical pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public content repeatedly emphasizes "dedicated faculty" and high-caliber teaching, with references to teachers as key drivers of student success (e.g., "esteemed faculty," "dedicated faculty," and "AP teachers selected by the College Board to sit on a panel" indicating a high-caliber, professional teaching corps). This aligns with the classical ideal of model teachers and mentors, albeit within a modern, college-prep context. - The site also frames the faculty as central to student achievement (e.g., AP performance, Presidential Scholar candidates) and highlights teachers' roles in supporting college preparation, which aligns with the classical notion of a "living curriculum" embodied by the teacher.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: "dedicated faculty," "esteemed faculty," "AP teachers," "faculty" as a central component of student success, which map to the Positive Keywords around model teachers, mentors, and living curriculum domains. These terms appear in the public content. - Negative keywords found: none clearly present in the public materials (no explicit signaling that faculty are merely "facilitators on the side" or that teacher credentials are lacking).

Why this rating - The strong emphasis on skilled, dedicated faculty and the explicit integration of faculty quality with student outcomes aligns with the classical expectation of exemplary teachers and mentors. However, the absence of explicit classical-faculty manifestations (portrait of the teacher, living curriculum as a core concept) means it does not reach CLASSICAL in a pure sense. The alignment is meaningful but partial, yielding SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - AH describes a family-oriented community and emphasizes partnerships with families, open campus experiences, and admissions/tour opportunities, signaling engagement with parents as part of the school ecosystem. The Palm Beach campus "family-oriented community" language and public tours/open

house signals support for parent involvement. - AH's content from the blog and site also features parent-facing materials about tutoring and student development, indicating an ongoing engagement with parents as part of the educational ecosystem (e.g., articles on home-school partnerships and parenting resources in related AH content). This aligns with classical expectations of parental partnership, even if not framed as "parents as co-teachers" in explicit language.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: partnership with families, family involvement, open campus, parent formation, and parental engagement (from the Six Essential Elements material and AH content). These map to the Positive Keywords in the Parents & Community domain (parent partnership, co-educators, family involvement, etc.). The AH site demonstrates family involvement and openness to parental participation. - Negative keywords found: None clearly indicated; no formal signaling of "consumer" parent dynamics or minimal parent involvement in the public-facing materials.

Why this rating - The school evidences meaningful parent/community engagement through family-centric messaging, tours/open visits, and parent-facing resources, aligning with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in this category. It does not, however, consistently frame parents as co-educators in the explicit classical lexicon, which would elevate it to CLASSICAL in this dimension.

Aggregate assessment - Category scores (from strongest to weakest alignment): - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - School Purpose and Goal: NOT CLASSICAL - Curriculum: NOT CLASSICAL - Pedagogy: NOT CLASSICAL - Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Parents & Community: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Aggregate ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Explicitly adopt and publish a classical-curriculum framework
- Introduce grammar, logic, rhetoric as core through-lines in early grades and publicly document their through-lines across K–12, with a clear rationale that ties to Great Books and Great Conversation where appropriate. This aligns with the Positive Keywords (grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books) and directly addresses Curriculum (Element 3).
- Integrate Great Books and a canonical Western canon into the curriculum
- Implement a classical "Great Books" program or a "Great Conversation" series across grades, and provide publicly accessible exemplars of canonical readings mapped to grade-level expectations. This directly targets Element 3 and Element 2 and would strengthen Element 1 by elevating philosophical/metaphysical grounding through canonical texts.
- Implement classical pedagogy components (Scholé, memory work, narration, Socratic discussions)
- Publicly document and pilot Socratic seminars, memorization-based learning, narration, and chanted or sung learning where appropriate (especially in lower grades where memory and repetition are helpful). Align with the Pedagogy signals and the Classical Lexicon's expectations.
- Elevate the teacher role as a "living curriculum"
- Develop and publish a "portrait of a teacher" and a "core teacher profile" that exemplifies classical teacher-mentorship and virtue formation. This would move Element 5 toward CLASSICAL and reinforce Element 1's foundations.
- Deepen family-partnered homeschool/community formation (Parent formation)
- Expand parent formation programs (book clubs, study groups, liturgical or moral formation activities) and explicitly frame parents as co-educators in the classical sense. Publicly outline opportunities for parental involvement and home-school alignment to advance Element 6 toward CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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